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Rendering Guide: QMD to HTML/PDF

This guide covers how to render all the `.qmd` files to HTML and PDF for deployment.

Quick Start

```
cd website
quarto render
```

That's it! Quarto will: - Render all `.qmd` files in `content/` to HTML and PDF - Output to `../docs/` folder - Create standalone HTML files (with embedded CSS/resources) - Generate PDF versions - Generate PowerPoint presentation - Copy resources (images) as needed

Before You Render

Prerequisites

1. **Install Quarto** (if not already installed)

```
# macOS
brew install quarto

# Or download from: https://quarto.org/docs/get-started/
```

2. Verify installation

```
quarto --version
```

What Gets Rendered

.qmd Files → HTML + PDF

Resources (pre-reading materials): - website/content/resources/what-is-ai.qmd → docs/what-is-ai.html + docs/what-is-ai.pdf - website/content/resources/what-are-llms.qmd → docs/what-are-llms.html + docs/what-are-llms.pdf - website/content/resources/quick-start-guide.qmd → docs/quick-start-guide.html + docs/quick-start-guide.pdf - website/content/resources/what-to-expect.qmd → docs/what-to-expect.html + docs/what-to-expect.pdf - website/content/resources/ai-in-pedagogical-design-and-delivery.qmd → docs/ai-in-pedagogical-design-and-delivery.html + .pdf - website/content/resources/cognitive-prompting-in-education.qmd → docs/cognitive-prompting-in-education.html + .pdf - website/content/resources/using-ai-in-education-roles-for-teaching-and-research.qmd → docs/using-ai-in-education-roles-for-teaching-and-research.html + .pdf

Materials (handouts, presentation, references): - website/content/materials/teaching-strategies-handout.qmd → HTML + PDF - website/content/materials/references.qmd → HTML + PDF - website/content/materials/presentation.qmd → HTML + PDF + PPTX

Assessment (already HTML)

- website/content/assessment/ai-literacy-diagnostic.html → (copied to docs/)

Static Website (copied as-is)

- website/src/index.html → docs/index.html
- website/src/resources.html → docs/resources.html
- website/src/materials.html → docs/materials.html
- website/src/css/style.css → docs/css/style.css
- website/src/images/ → docs/images/

Render Output Features

HTML Files

- **Standalone:** All CSS and resources embedded (one file = complete)
- **Table of Contents:** Auto-generated from headings
- **Responsive:** Works on mobile and desktop
- **Searchable:** Can search within the page
- **Printable:** Print-friendly styling

PDF Files

- **Professional:** Formatted for printing
- **Navigation:** Table of contents with clickable links
- **Color-coded:** Headings and links in color
- **Metadata:** Title, author, date in document properties

PowerPoint (PPTX)

- **Presentation-ready:** Use for live presenting
- **Slide per section:** Each top-level heading = one slide
- **Images embedded:** All presentation images included
- **Editable:** Customize in PowerPoint/Google Slides as needed

Quarto Configuration

The rendering is configured in `website/_quarto.yml`:

```
project:
  type: default
  output-dir: ../docs          # Output to docs/
  resources:
    - src/images/              # Include images

render:
  - content/**/*.qmd          # Render all .qmd files

format:
  html:
    embed-resources: true      # Standalone HTML files
```

```

    toc: true                # Table of contents
    embed-resources: true
    css: src/css/style.css   # Use website CSS

pdf:
  toc: true                 # PDF also has TOC
  colorlinks: true          # Colored links in PDF

execute:
  freeze: auto              # Cache execution results

```

Before Rendering

Check that: 1. All .qmd files have YAML front matter (between --- lines) 2. Image paths in presentation are correct: ../src/images/filename.png 3. No syntax errors in .qmd files

Rendering Commands

Render everything

```

cd website
quarto render

```

Render a specific file

```

cd website
quarto render content/resources/what-is-ai.qmd

```

Render to specific format

```

cd website
quarto render content/materials/presentation.qmd --to html
quarto render content/materials/presentation.qmd --to pdf
quarto render content/materials/presentation.qmd --to pptx

```

Preview in browser while editing

```
cd website  
quarto preview
```

Then open: <http://localhost:4949>

After Rendering

Check the output

```
ls -la docs/
```

You should see: - *.html files (standalone HTML) - *.pdf files (PDFs) - presentation.pptx (PowerPoint) - css/style.css (copied) - images/ folder (copied) - Static HTML pages

Test the links

1. Open docs/index.html in browser
2. Click “Resources” → all links should work
3. Click “Materials” → all links should work
4. Try downloading PDFs

Deploy to GitHub Pages

```
git add docs/  
git commit -m "Render QMD files to HTML and PDF"  
git push origin main
```

GitHub Pages auto-deploys from docs/ folder.

Troubleshooting

“command not found: quarto”

- Install Quarto: `brew install quarto` (or download from quarto.org)
- Or use full path: `/usr/local/bin/quarto render`

Images not showing in rendered HTML

- Check image paths in .qmd files (should be ../src/images/filename.png)
- Verify images exist in website/src/images/
- Make sure _quarto.yml includes resources: - src/images/

Links broken in rendered HTML

- Links in website/src/resources.html and website/src/materials.html should point to ../filename.html
- These files point to the rendered output in docs/

PDF generation failing

- Install a PDF rendering engine: `quarto install tinytex`
- Or use Quarto's built-in PDF support

PPTX presentation looking wrong

- Check that image paths use ../src/images/ format
- Use ![] (path/to/image.png) syntax (not HTML img tags)
- Each top-level # heading becomes one slide

Common Issues

Changed a .qmd but it didn't update

- Quarto caches results; use `quarto render --no-cache`

Want to rebuild everything from scratch

```
rm -rf docs/  
quarto render
```

Different output wanted for different formats

Use format-specific YAML in the front matter:

```
format:
  html:
    embed-resources: true
    toc: true
  pdf:
    toc: false
    margin-left: 1in
  pptx:
    footer: "Your footer here"
```

Workflow

1. **Edit .qmd file** → Make changes in `website/content/`
2. **Render** → `quarto render`
3. **Preview** → Open rendered HTML in browser
4. **Deploy** → `git add docs/` and push to GitHub
5. **Visit live site** → <https://michaelborck-presentations.github.io/...>

Tips

- Use `quarto preview` while editing for live reload
- Use `quarto render --watch` to auto-render on file changes
- Keep .qmd files in `website/content/`, not `website/src/`
- Static HTML pages (`index.html`, `resources.html`, etc.) go in `website/src/`
- Let Quarto handle the rendering; don't edit rendered HTML files directly

Questions?

See `WEBSITE-BUILD-GUIDE.md` for more details on the build process.